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EDITORIAL NOTE

The Editor-in-Chief, on behalf of the members of the Editorial Board, is pleased to present to the research community the world over, Jewel Journal of Politics from the Department of Political Science, Gombe State, Nigeria. JJOP is envisioned to provide a common ground for researchers, academicians, and professionals to publish their work especially in the arrears of humanities and social sciences for the benefit of humanity.

The Journal from the onset strived to constitute and enrich members of the Editorial Board with a view to ensure critical assessment and quality-oriented production of knowledge through rigorous review of submissions of papers to ensure they meet the requisite standard. The journal also is very mindful of some of the challenges authors face especially the lengthy review process; this is avoided and equally very mindful of not compromising standard and quality.

JJOP provides unique opportunities to researchers, academicians and professionals to be able to publish timely and at a very cheaper rate. JJOP is indexed Online-ISSN 28142381 and Print/offline ISSN28142373.

The Editor-in-Chief is very grateful for the laudable support and commitment from the members of the Editorial Board towards the growth and development of this journal for the benefit of humanity.

Assoc. Prof. Bashir Malam

The Editor-in-Chief,
August, 2024

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The Challenges and Prospects of Cotton Production in Gombe State: A Political Economy Perspective

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Abstract

The global cotton industry is one of the cornerstones of the global economy. It is projected to grow from USD 637.1 million in 2021 to USD 6,730.9 million by 2028 at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 40.0% during the period 2021-2028. This makes it one of the largest and most competitive markets in the world, producing about 25% of the world's raw materials. More than 400 million people worldwide are involved in cotton cultivation, accounting for more than 10% of all agricultural workers worldwide. In Nigeria, before the oil boom, the main source of Nigeria's foreign exchange is cotton and it is the second largest employer of labor in the public sector and employed more than 2 million families and provided them with means of livelihood. However, this vibrant sector, due to some challenges, turned into a shadow of itself. Therefore, this study examines the challenges and prospects of cotton production in Gombe state from the political economy perspective. The study used the Marxist political economy theory as a result of its veritable explanations of the relationship between economic productions. A descriptive research design was employed and both primary and secondary sources of data were used while Chi-Square propounded by Karl Parson was used to test the research hypothesis. 360 copies of questionnaire were sampled using Morgan and Krejcie from 5721 cotton farmers of which 351 were returned. The research among other things found out that the problem of insecurity (Headsmen attacks), lack of good seedlings and pesticides, as well as pricing, are the major challenges bedeviling cotton farmers which ultimately led to the decline of cotton production in Gombe State. The research, therefore recommended that the aforementioned challenges should be properly addressed by government institutions, private agencies, and individuals and come up with strategies that will revive the cotton sector which will enhance Nigeria's economic growth and development.

Keywords: Cotton, Production, Political Economy, Perspective, Challenges, and Prospects

Introduction

The cotton plant is, globally, regarded as one of the most important commercial crops because of the role it plays in the economic, social, and political affairs of the world (International Cotton Advisory Committee (ICAC), 2012). The production of cotton is a vital component of the global economy. Cotton is a versatile and highly sought-after commodity, used in a variety of industries, from apparel to home furnishings. As such, it is essential to ensure that the production of cotton is efficient and sustainable. This is because it accounts for more than 50% of all fibers that are used in the textile industry and it is increasing all over the world in more than 100 countries. It is more beneficial than many fibers, hence it is recognized as the most useful natural fiber across the globe for textile production (Acquaah, 2007). Also, it is projected to grow from USD 637.1 million in 2021 to USD 6,730.9 million

by 2028 at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 40.0% during the period 2021-2028. This makes it one of the largest and most competitive markets in the world, producing about 25% of the world's raw materials. More than 400 million people worldwide are involved in cotton cultivation, accounting for more than 10% of all agricultural workers worldwide (Vizbibe, 2022). This justifies the fact that cotton fiber plays a pivotal role in accelerating the economic growth and development of more than one hundred countries across the globe by creating millions of job opportunities for youths in textile industries and rural farmers.

In Africa, the production of cotton on the continent is an important part of the global cotton industry, and it is a vital part of the African economy. Cotton production in Africa is a major source of income for many African countries. Cotton production in Africa is also an important source of employment for many people, providing jobs and livelihoods for millions of people across the continent (Amanet et al., 2019). Additionally, Hussein (2010) observed that in most West African countries cotton is the major contributor to the agricultural revolution. He however argued that, even though African cotton production is not highly significant on a global scale, most of its countries are heavily dependent on the outlet of cotton production. For example in the Benin Republic cotton accounts for more than 60% of their earnings from foreign exchange.

Nigeria's cotton production before the oil boom was a major source of economic growth and development. This is evidenced by the fact that cotton was the country's leading export from the late 19th century until the 1950s (Ahmed, 2008). On the international market, cotton is the major agricultural product that boosted Nigeria's export. It employed more than 2 million families and provide them with means of livelihood. Hence it is regarded as the most important agricultural and industrial crop in Nigeria (Ahmed, 2008). He went further to disclose that 24 out of 36 states produce average annual cotton of about 250,000 metric tons. Unfortunately, during the oil boom of the 1970s and 80s, Nigeria abandoned its agricultural sector. One of the major consequences of this negligence of the agricultural sector was the total decline in fiber and food production and the hike of inputs price astronomically. These problems of the sector have overwhelmingly affected the cotton sector which is an important pillar of Nigeria's economy.

Gombe State, being the focus of this research, is one of the emirates which was carved out of the Sokoto Caliphate from the year of its existence i.e. 1804-1903. This political community covered about 150,000 square miles. Gombe State is directly linked to its creation from the old Bauchi State on October 1st, 1996 by the Late General Sani Abacha's administration (1993-1998) (Mairiga, cited in Saleh, 2017). They went further to reveal that historical evidence abounds to show that the history of cotton production in the state dated back to the period before 1800, and in the early years of Nigeria's independence, the Gombe division (now state) produced 19,000 tones i.e. 1/5 of Nigeria's cotton.

Methodology

In an academic environment, research is essentially an investigation, recording, and enhancement of existing knowledge. Research is a systematic method of acquiring knowledge and not by arbitrary trial and error. According to Ezeani (2011), research is the process of finding reliable solutions to a problem through a systematic and planned collection, analysis, presentation and interpretation of data. This research is anchored on descriptive survey research design. It is aimed at collecting data on the challenges and prospects of cotton production in Gombe state. The method integrated both quantitative and qualitative methods demonstrating the need for a research plan that enable numerical

description of the study population. The study period is 2019-2022. The selection of this stage is reasonable because of continuous efforts to improve the production of cotton not only in Nigeria but also across the globe. The survey approach is carried out through observational studies and selecting samples from the population (cotton farmers in Gombe State). The population comprised all cotton producers in the Gombe state which are 5721 as revealed to the researcher by the National Cotton Association of Nigeria (NACOTAN) Gombe State Chapter.

Sampling Frame, Sampling Technique, and Sample Size

The sampling frame is used to select a number of individuals for the study to represent the larger group from which they will be selected. According to Nwizu (2008) a sample is a truly representative or subset of the population. Sampling arose in research, because of the need to avoid bias and also because neither time nor other resources will allow for a complete census. In this regard, the purposive sampling technique is used to select the sample from the entire population. Purposive sampling is a technique used to select participants for a study based on predetermined criteria. Therefore, in this study, the researchers purposely selected three (3) local governments that have highest cotton production in the state with each senatorial district represented by one (1) which include Balanga, Yamaltu Deba, and Kwami Local Governments representing Gombe South, Central, and North respectively. Two data collection sources were used to obtain relevant information for the study, namely primary source and secondary source. The primary data have been collected through questionnaire, interview, and direct observations. On the other hand, the secondary data have been collected from journals, related books, periodicals, articles, internet sources, government releases and statements.

Method of Data Presentation and Analysis

This study used chi-square and content analysis to answer the research questions, drawn a conclusion. As revealed by Makodi (2006), the formula of Chi-Square was developed by Karl Pearson. It measures statistical discrepancy between observed and expected values or frequencies. In calculating chi-square, a comparison involving observed and expected (theoretical) frequencies would require distribution. While observed frequencies refer to direct observation of the phenomenon, event, group, or proportion being studied, the expected frequencies refer to those that are expected.

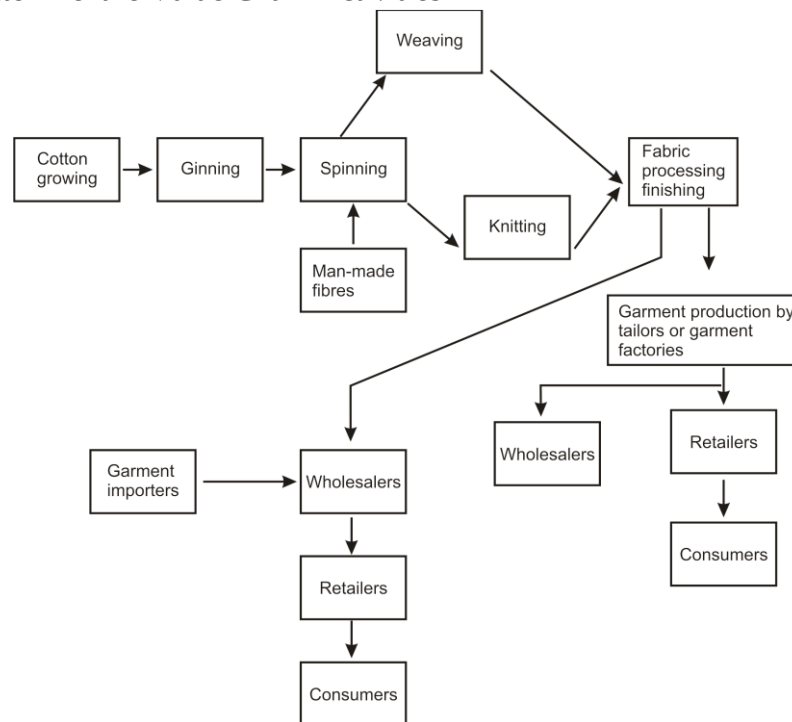
Literature Review

The English word "cotton" (*Gossypium hirsutum*) originated from the Arabic word "Qutub". The exact origin of cotton fiber and the first time used by human beings is not known. However, the record of the oldest archaeological of cotton textiles dated back to 3,000B.C which was obtained in the valley of the Indus River of West Pakistan (Fisher, 1969). United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) (2016) revealed that cultivated cotton traced its origin from Pre-Columbian America (especially in Guatemala and Peru) and expand to Mexico from these areas. Thus, cotton is one of the most widely used fabrics in the world, and its history is as interesting as its various uses. Cotton was an important part of the ancient world, and it was used to make clothing, bedding, and other items. It was also used for trading and commerce, and it was highly valued for its softness and durability. Cotton was so important in the ancient world that it was even used as currency in some parts of the world. Today, cotton is still widely used and is one of the most popular fabrics in the world. It is used to make clothing, bedding, towels, and many other items. Its popularity is due to its softness, durability, and affordability. It is no surprise that cotton is still so widely used today, as it has been a part of our lives for thousands of years.

Economic Importance of Cotton

One peculiar of the importance of cotton is the fact that it is the world's most widely natural fiber which has been recognized as the undisputed monarch of the world textile industry to date. When it comes to economic acceleration, the cotton sector has contributed immensely to the advancement of developed and developing nations as well as the improvement of the living conditions of millions of people especially the rural smallholders across the globe. In 2019, global cotton production was valued at over 46 billion USD, while international trade amounted to 15 billion USD. Moreover, it is estimated that in 75 countries cotton sector alone employs more than 150 million people, making the sector a significant contributor to the achievement of the world agenda 2030 for sustainable development (Food and Agricultural Organization, 2020). More importantly, cotton served as the major source of livelihood for more than 1 billion people, out of which 100 million are farmers that produce cotton while 250 million are working as its processors. Approximately, 90% of cotton producers are peasants located in developing countries, mainly in Asia and Africa. It employs about 7% of the complete labor force in developing countries (Innovation Forum, 2015; World Wild Fund, 2020).

Figure 1.1: Cotton Textile Value Chain Activities



Source: CBN Annual Report 2006

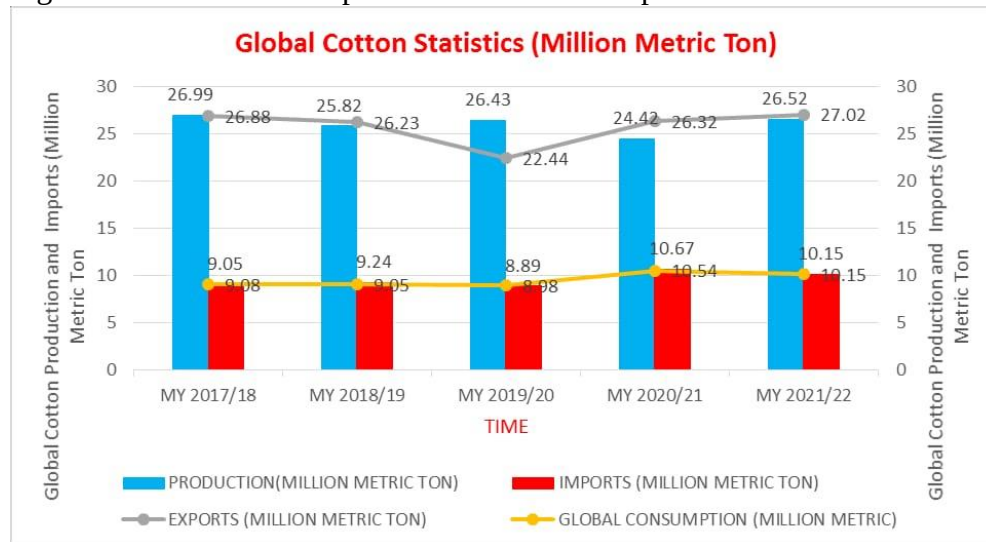
Therefore, Cotton production is of immense economic importance to many countries around the world. It is a major source of income for millions of people, and its production has a positive impact on global economic growth.

Global Trends in Cotton Production and Consumption

Textile utilization has dramatically increased which was driven by income growth and population, especially in developing countries like Asia. Also, the demand for cotton fiber has increased quite markedly in recent times. However, despite this, faces several uncertainties in both the area of production and consumption which needs to be adequately addressed before the sector actualizes its full potential in accelerating economic growth and

development. According to Fiber2Passion, (2021) it is expected that global cotton production and consumption will be improved in the upcoming years as a result of better crop yield in Pakistan, Australia, and Brazil which substitute for the production loss in Greece. Presently, cotton consumption is constantly rising because of the increasing demand to mitigate the effect of COVID-19 in Mexico, India, Bangladesh, and Pakistan. The following diagram demonstrated the statistical analysis of cotton production and consumption globally:

Figure 1.2: Global cotton production and consumption statistics



Source: TexPro & USDA, Shahbandeh, (2023), compiled by the researchers.

The chart above simply means that world cotton production was 26.43 million tons in the 2019-2020 marketing year (MY), down 7.60% to 24.42 million tons in 2020-2021 by Fiber2Fashion, according to Fiber2Fashion's market analysis tool TexPro. But it is expected to recover to 26.52 million tonnes in the 2021-22 marketing year with an increase of 8.60%.

Theoretical framework

This research can best be described upon the premise of the Marxist theory of political economy. The selection of the theory is a result of its veritable explanations of the relationship between politics and the economy and offered a vital analysis of the relationship between economic productions. The term "Political Economy" comes from the Greek word "Politicos-Oicos-Nomos" which means household management. The phrase refers to the study of the relationships between buying, selling, and production in a society with respect to law, culture, and government. This approach dates back to the moral philosophers of the late 18th century, especially Adam Smith. As the field began to develop, it turned to the mathematical analysis of consumption and production rather than the relationships of the entire social, political, and economic structure. As a result, political economy has largely been replaced by the term economics (Batatina, 2024).

In the literature, political economy is discussed in two main ways, namely: A descriptive term and theoretical approach. As a descriptive term, political economy refers to the sectors of the economy that are controlled by political institutions and used to sustain that entity (Feinman, 2004). In contrast, as a theoretical approach, political economy provides a model that can be used to analyze the function and integration of an economy within a political entity (Stanish, et al. 1992). Today, the political economy approach generally refers to a set of separate but related approaches to the study of the political and economic behavior of

individuals and groups. It often involves combining the tools of economics with those of the other social sciences (Batatina, 2024). At the same time, Anifowose and Enemou (1999) assert that political economy as an approach, probes the depth of issues, the relationship of phenomena, policies, etc., to know their origin, characteristics and class composition, and the logic of their existence and future. Therefore, it does not consider problems superficially. Thus, Marx's theory and approach to political economy is based on historical materialism and dialectical materialism. The basic assumption of Marxist Political Economy is centered on three major points namely: economic interpretation of history; surplus value and economic exploitation; and alternative planned economic development (socialist economy).

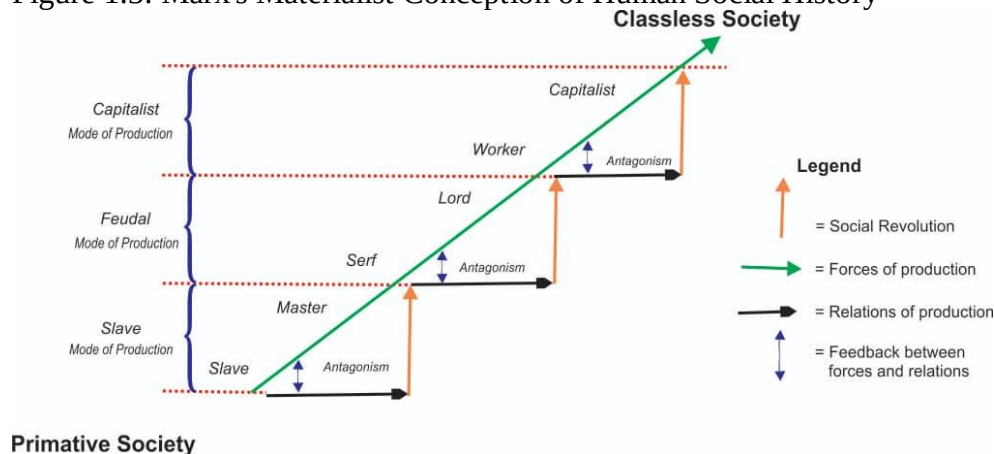
Economic Interpretation of History

The approach assumed that the economy is the substructure upon which another sub-structural edifice of society revolves. Using his logic of dialectical materialism and historical determinism, Marx verified the evidence of contentious contradiction in every economic period from slavery to capitalism and class struggle in each period (Caporogo & Levine, 1992). Marx asserted that conflict is a driving force in history. He believed that an individual's place in the class hierarchy was determined by his role in the production process (Marx, 1979). He distinguishes one class from another on the basis of two criteria: ownership of the means of production and the right to control the labor power of others. From there, he defined modern society as three distinct classes:

First, the capitalist who is the one that owns the means of production and buys the labor power of others. The second category is the worker or the proletariat who has no means of production or the ability to purchase labor power. Finally, a small transitional class called the petty bourgeoisie who possesses the means of production but does not purchase labor power (Caporogo & Levine, 1992).

The central thrust of Marxist theory of political economy is that economic and wealth distributions were characterized by domineering, a situation in which a strong class dominates a weaker class. Karl Marx, a 19th-century economic and political philosopher, argued that this market expansion and increased flow of goods and services would be the shape capitalist society would take as it developed. Karl Marx believed that history goes through stages that Frederick Engels called "historical materialism". He looked at these periods through an economic lens; those with higher productive capacity will naturally exclude those with lower productive capacity (Marx, 1979).

Figure 1.3: Marx's Materialist Conception of Human Social History



Surplus value and Economic Exploitation

One of the cornerstones of Marxist political economy is Karl Marx's ideas around the labor theory of value. Labor theory of value holds that the value of any good is determined by the average time it takes to produce that good (Smith & Butovsky, 2012). An example of labor value theory is that if a t-shirt takes half the time to make a hat, then the price of the hat will be twice the price of the t-shirt. The critique of capitalism by Marxist economics mainly focuses on the distribution of surplus product and surplus value. Specifically, Marx argued that the capitalist class enriches itself by exploiting others. Marx concluded that the wages of the workers must be proportional to the labor of the workers. The concept of labor power gave rise to Marx's question about the distribution of surplus value in a capitalist society. He argues that capitalists overwork their employees to make a profit, causing employees to create more value than they are paid for. The two main criticisms of Marxist economics of capitalism are that capitalism alienates workers and that surplus products and surplus value is not distributed equitably. Karl Marx argued that capitalism alienates people; moreover, he argues that this happens due to supply and demand in the open market (Marx, 1979).

Marx suggested that the spontaneous nature of the free market forces people to overwork and do jobs they don't want to do. Furthermore, he argued that capitalism did not distribute surplus product and surplus value equitably, because owners and landlords would overwork their workers to make a profit. Smith saw the price of a good in terms of the labor that a buyer must pay to purchase it, which represents the concept of how much labor a good, such as a tool, can save for buyer. LTV is central to Marxist theory, which argues that the working class is exploited under capitalism, and separate price from value (Marx, 1979).

Socialist Economy

Karl Marx who was regarded as the most prominent voice of socialism believed that the injustice faced by the working class in the capitalist system would trigger them to rise against their exploiters, a situation that will usher in a socialist economic system. This economic system is based on the collective ownership of the means of production, the emphasis on equality and economic security, and central planning of the economy, to reduce class distinctions (Marx, 1979).

The Applicability of Political Economy Approach to this Study

The application of this approach to this study is that looking at the conclusion made by Marxist Political Economy that the aim of all capitalists is to increase their surplus value through the exploitation of surplus labor of the working class in which the laborers receive nothing, is one of the major reasons why Nigeria's cotton production is perpetually declining. Also, from the perspective of the capitalists' exploitative policies, looking at the pre-colonial, colonial, and post-colonial cotton production in Nigeria, the fortunes of cotton production and marketing in Nigeria are still repulsive.

The Critiques of the Political Economy Approach

The major critique against the Marxist Political Economy Approach includes his "overemphasis" on economic forces, his critics also noted that the plight of workers in capitalist economies has improved rather than worsened as projected and that his anticipated revolution to be carried out by the masses didn't occur, thus described his approach as inconsistent. In addition, the free market has proven to show sustainable long-term economic growth (Anifowose & Enemou, 1999).

Data Presentation and Analysis on the Challenges and Prospects of Cotton Production in Gombe State

The essence of this section is to present and analyze the data collected for the study. The presentation and analysis were based on the responses gotten from the respondents (Cotton farmers) through the questionnaire administered on them. The data are presented and analyzed using tables. The copies of questionnaire were distributed to the selected 360 cotton farmers in Gombe State out of which 351 copies were returned. Three (3) local governments, Balanga, Yamaltu Deba, and Kwami were purposely selected, representing the three Senatorial Districts of Gombe South, Gombe Central, and Gombe North respectively.

Table 1.1: Bio Data of the Respondents

Sex Distribution			
Variable	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
Male	328	93%	93
Female	23	7%	100
Senatorial District			
Variable	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
Gombe South	97	28%	28
Gombe Central	124	35%	63
Gombe North	130	37%	100
Age			
Variable	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
17-25	20	6%	6
26-35	31	37%	43
36- 45	125	36%	79
46-Above	75	21%	100
Marital Status			
Variable	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
Single	32	9%	9
Married	313	89%	98
Divorced	6	2%	100
Educational Background			
Variable	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
Non-formal Education	204	58%	58
Primary Education	58	17%	75
Secondary Education	53	15%	90
Higher Education	36	10%	100
Occupational Distribution			
Variable	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
Farming	196	56%	56
Civil Service and Farming	48	14%	70
Business and farming	107	30%	100

Source: Field Study: 2023

The above table revealed that the age bracket of the cotton farmers in the study as follows: those within 17-25 years old constitute 6% of the respondents while those from 26-35 years constitute 37%, those from 36-45 years old constitute 36% of the respondents while those from 46 years old and above, constitute 21% of the respondents. This disclosed that those between 26 to 35 and 36-45 years old are the major cotton farmers in the study area which means that youth are predominantly cotton farmers in Gombe State. It is clearly indicated

from the above table that 89% of the respondents are married, 9% of the respondents are single and 2% of the respondents are divorced which means married people are predominantly the cotton farmers in the study area.

Also, it revealed that 58% of the respondents have non-formal education, 17% of the respondents have primary education, 15% of the respondents have secondary education, while only 10% of the respondents have higher education which means that those that have no formal education are predominantly cotton farmers in the study area. The table also revealed that 56% of the respondents farming is their major occupation, 14% is civil service and farming, 30% take business and farming as their major occupation. This disclosed that farming is the major occupation of the respondents in the study area. In terms of cotton farming experience, 14% of the respondents have less than five years' experience, 32% of the respondents have 6-10 years cotton farming experience, while 54% of the respondents have over 10 years' experience in cotton farming which means that the majority of cotton farmers have more than 10 years' experience in cotton farming.

Table 1.2: **Challenges Prospects of Cotton Production in Gombe State**

Cotton Farming Experience			
Variables	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
Less than 5Years	48	14%	14
6-10 Years	114	32%	46
Above 10 Years	189	54%	100
Challenges and Prospects of Cotton Production			
Variables	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
Herdsman Attacks	87	25%	25
Financial Challenges	23	7%	32
Pricing Problem	71	20%	52
Lack of Good and Enough Fertilizer	17	5%	57
Lack of Enough Plot of Land	6	2%	59
Lack of Good Seedling and pesticide	82	23%	82
Lack of Adequate Buyers	53	15%	97
Lack of Modern Farming Tools	11	3%	100

Source: Field Study, 2023

The above table clearly demonstrated that the most daunting challenges militating against cotton production in the study area are many. 25% of the respondents reveals that herdsman attacks is their major challenge to cotton production, 7% disclosed that financial challenge is their major problem, 20% revealed that pricing problem is their major challenge, 5% revealed that lack of good and enough fertilizer is their major challenge, 2% disclosed that lack of enough plot of land is their major challenge, 23% disclosed that lack of good seedlings and pesticide is their major problem, 15% are of the view that lack of adequate cotton buyers is their major problem, while 3% of the respondents revealed that lack of modern farming tools is their major challenge to cotton production. This means that the top three (3) major challenges of cotton production in Gombe state are insecurity (herdsman attacks) which constitute 25% of the problem followed by lack of good seedling and pesticides which constitutes 23% of the problem, then followed by pricing problem which constitutes 20% of the challenges.

Table 1.3: Possible Solutions to the challenges of Cotton Production in Gombe State

Variables	Frequency	Percentage	Cumulative
Provision of enough security	88	25%	25
Establishment of cotton price board	36	10%	35
Provision of Good Seedling and pesticide	83	24%	59
Provision of soft loan to cotton farmers	21	6%	65
Reservation of plot of land solely cotton farming	8	2%	67
Provision of Enough Subsidized Fertilizer	40	11%	78
Availability of Adequate Buyers	58	17%	95
Provision of Modern Farming Tools	17	5%	100

Source: Field Study, 2023

The above table revealed possible solutions provided by the respondents on the challenges of cotton production in the study area where 25% of the respondents believe that prohibition of adequate security will help them to boost cotton production in this state, 10% of the respondents suggested establishment of cotton price control board, 24% of the respondents suggested provision of good seedlings and pesticides, 6% of the respondents suggested provision of soft loan to cotton farmers which will address financial issues, 2% of the respondents suggested a reservation of plot of land by government solely for cotton farming, 11% of the respondents suggested provision of enough subsidized fertilizer, 17% of the respondents suggested that there should be availability of adequate buyers which will address pricing issues, 5% of the respondents suggested provision of modern farming tools to boost cotton farming in the state.

Testing of Hypothesis

H^0 : Cotton production in Gombe State is not affected by challenges confronting farmers.

This hypothesis is tested based on data in table2 as follows:

Table 1.4: Calculated Chi-Square

Variables	O	E	(O-E)	(O-E) ²	(O-E) ² e
Headmen Attacks	87	50.14	36.86	1358.66	27.10
Financial Challenges	23	50.14	-27.14	736.58	14.69
Pricing Problem	71	50.14	20.86	435.14	8.68
Lack of Enough Plot of Land	6	50.14	-44.14	1948.34	38.86
Lack of Good Seedling and pesticide	82	50.14	31.86	1015.06	20.24
Lack of Adequate Buyers	53	50.14	2.86	8.18	0.16
Lack of Modern Farming Tools	11	50.14	-39.14	1531.94	30.55
Lack of Good and Enough Fertilizer	17	50.14	-33.14	1098.26	21.90
				Total	162.18

Source: Field Study, 2023

Degree of freedom is given as Level of significance =5% Or $5/100 = 0.05$

From the critical values of chi-square table, critical value = 14.067 at the degree freedom of 7. While our calculated = 126.18

Decision Rule:

If calculated is greater than critical value, accept the alternative hypothesis, otherwise reject.

Decision:

Since calculated (126.18) is greater than critical value (14.0.67) the researcher accept the alternative hypothesis, which implies that cotton production in Gombe state is affected by challenges bedeviling farmers.

Findings

The major findings of the research include:

1. The research found out that problem of insecurity (headsmen attacks), lack of good seedlings and pesticides, pricing, are the top 3 challenges bedeviling cotton famers which ultimately led to the decline of cotton production in Gombe State. Other challenges include pricing and financial challenges, as well as lack of enough subsided fertilizer, among others.
2. The research also established that the dual exploitation of cotton farmers by the bourgeoisie and petty-bourgeoisie in the sphere of production, marketing, and exchange, compounded their poverty level, thereby discouraging or forcing them to run away from cotton production or increasing its production.
3. In addition, the research found that the failure of government at all levels to take necessary actions to procure inputs for distribution to farmers, adequate security, coupled with inadequate incentives compounded the tragedy of cotton production in Gombe State.
4. Government is reluctant to establish the much desired cotton gazette markets, textile industries, and to ensure strict compliance to the market rules and regulations.

Conclusion

Cotton production in Gombe State is an important economic activity that has the potential to bring much-needed economic growth and development to the region. The challenges of cotton production in Gombe State are numerous. Insecurity, pricing problem, poor infrastructure, lack of access to markets, and inadequate access to credit, lack of good seedlings and pesticides, are all major obstacles to the success of cotton production in Gombe State. Additionally, the region is suffering from a lack of skilled labor, as well as a lack of access to modern technology. These challenges must be addressed in order for cotton production in Gombe State to be successful. However, despite the challenges, there are some prospects for cotton production in Gombe State. The state is home to some of the best soil in the country, and the climate is ideal for the cultivation of cotton. Additionally, the government of Gombe State has taken steps to some extent to improve the infrastructure in the state, which has made it easier for farmers to access markets and credit. Finally, the government has also taken steps to improve access to modern technology, which has helped to increase productivity and efficiency.

Recommendations

Based on the findings of this research, the following recommendations are provided:

1. To address the most daunting challenge bedeviling cotton farmers which is headsmen attacks, government, traditional rulers, headsmen leaders, farmers associations, and the general public, need to collaborate and work together assiduously to address it. If this problem is address, farmers would massively return back to cotton farming which will contribute in reviving cotton sector not only in Gombe State but also other parts of Nigeria;
2. With the right policies and investments, Gombe State can become a major player in the cotton production industry. Therefore, sound policies should be initiated and implemented to sustain cotton sector in the state.

3. Cotton Research and Development Centers should be established and adequately funded to carry out research on different contemporary issues on cotton. Under these centers, capacity building and awareness on the modern ways of cotton farming should be regularly carried out to strengthen the capacity of cotton farmers financially and otherwise in the state and beyond.

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